

AWS MLU FACULTY FELLOWSHIP

Workshop One · Student Companion

Git + GitHub for Faculty

A step-by-step, browser-only walkthrough you can finish even if you fall behind, miss a moment, or get stuck.

60 MINUTES · **BROWSER-ONLY — NO INSTALL**

Delaware State University · College of Agriculture, Science & Technology

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How to use this companion

This is your step-by-step walkthrough for the live workshop. It is designed so that **you can finish the hands-on work even if you fall behind, miss a moment, or get stuck** — there are 600 of us, so the room cannot stop for one question.

Three ways to use it

- **Follow along live.** Keep this open next to your GitHub tab. Each numbered step matches a moment in the live session.
- **Catch up if you fall behind.** Each section is self-contained. Skip ahead to where the instructor is and use this to fill in what you missed.
- **Re-do it solo afterwards.** Everything you need to reproduce the workshop on your own is in this document.

Signposts you will see throughout

Signpost	Meaning
 Do this	An action for you to take.
You should see	What success looks like on your screen (blue box).
If you get stuck	Inline troubleshooting (amber box).
Why this matters	Short context that makes the step stick (gold box).

Session timing strip

Keep an eye on the instructor's clock. The two highlighted blocks are the hands-on — if you only stay focused for one stretch, stay focused from minute 23 to minute 48.

0–5	5–13	13–23	23–35	35–48	48–55	55–60
Welcome	Git literacy	GitHub tour	Fork	Edit & Commit	github.dev	Preview & wrap

Before the session — Pre-work

Do this at least 24 hours ahead.

You cannot complete the live hands-on without a working GitHub account.

1. Create a free GitHub account

- ▶ Go to <https://github.com/signup>
- ▶ Enter your **email** (a personal email is fine; an institutional email is also fine).
- ▶ Choose a **password**.
- ▶ Choose a **username** — this will appear in every URL of every repository you create, so pick something you are comfortable with publicly. Many faculty use `firstname-lastname` or `lastname-institution`.
- ▶ Solve the puzzle, then click **Create account**.
- ▶ Open your email and click the GitHub verification link.

YOU SHOULD SEE

Your new GitHub home page at github.com, with your avatar in the top-right corner.

2. Confirm you can sign in

- ▶ Sign out, then sign back in at github.com. Confirm it works **without** a password reset.

IF YOU GET STUCK

If you get a “device verification” email — that is normal. Click the link in the email to confirm the new sign-in.

3. Open these three tabs and bookmark them

Tab	URL	What it is
1	github.com	Your home page when signed in
2	github.com/aws-dsu/my-first-repo	The practice repo you will fork
3	github.dev	Browser-based code editor (bonus segment)

4. Pre-work checklist — “You’re ready when...”

- ☐ I can sign in to github.com without resetting my password.
- ☐ My username appears in the top-right corner of github.com when I am signed in.
- ☐ I can open github.com/aws-dsu/my-first-repo and read the README.
- ☐ I have this companion document open on a second monitor or in a second window.

Part 0 · Setup (0–5 min)

Watch & listen. The instructor will set ground rules for the room. While they talk, get your screen ready.

- ▶ Confirm you are **signed in** to github.com. Look for your avatar in the top-right.
- ▶ Open the practice repo in a second tab: **<https://github.com/aws-dsu/my-first-repo>**
- ▶ Keep this companion document visible.

Room norms to know

- **Stay muted.** The room will not be unmuted.
- **Chat is for clarifying questions only.** Three named moderators will answer.
- **If you fall behind, do not panic** — the session is recorded with chapter markers and there are 72 hours of async help afterwards.

BY THE END OF THIS HOUR, YOU WILL HAVE

1. Forked a real repository.
2. Made your first commit.
3. Opened a full code editor in a browser tab — no install.

Part 1 · Git Literacy (5–13 min)

Watch & capture. The instructor will define git and GitHub. Capture these two definitions — they are the ones you can keep.

Git is a time machine for files.
GitHub is the cloud where time machines live.

The four verbs you will keep hearing

Verb	What it does	Browser equivalent (today)
clone	Copy a repository from GitHub down to a computer or cloud environment.	Fork — creates your own copy on GitHub.
edit	Change one or more files.	Pencil icon on github.com, or github.dev.
commit	Save a labeled snapshot of your changes to the project history.	Commit changes button.
sync	Send your commits up to GitHub, or pull GitHub's commits down.	Sync button in github.dev.

Today's loop: F.E.C.

The three moves you will practice this hour:

F E C
Fork Edit Commit

- **F — Fork:** Click the Fork button on a repo page. Now you own a copy. The original is untouched.
- **E — Edit:** Click the pencil icon. Change the file in the web editor. Your fork only.
- **C — Commit:** Click Commit changes. Save a labeled snapshot. It is now in your history.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Fork ≈ Remix. The mental move you practice today is the same one you will practice in PartyRock next session.

Five reasons educators learn git

Skim this — do not memorize.

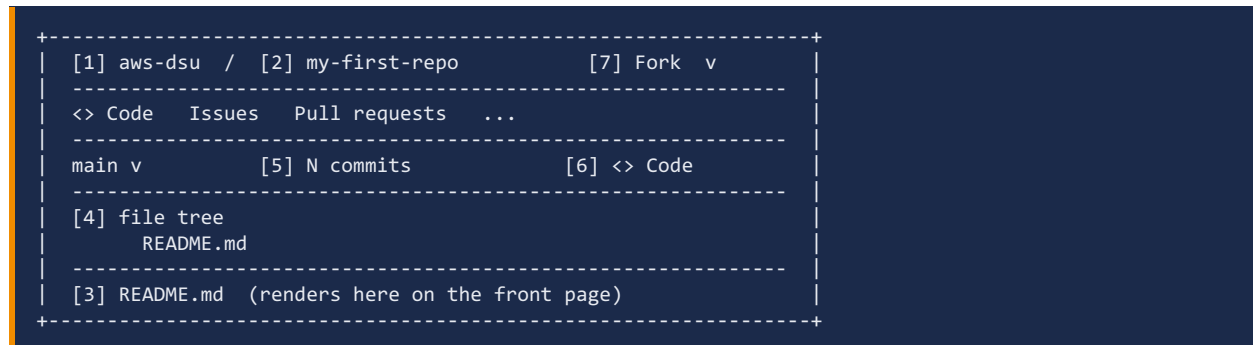
1. **Distribute materials** — push course resources to students with one link, and update them in place.
2. **Customize official labs** — fork AWS or vendor materials and adapt them for your syllabus.

3. **Pull updates cleanly** — when AWS revises a lab, pull updates into your fork without redoing your edits.
4. **Public teaching portfolio** — your repos become a durable, citable record of your course design.
5. **Collaborate with peers** — co-author labs with colleagues across institutions.

Part 2 · GitHub Tour (13–23 min)

Watch & label. The instructor will live-tour github.com/aws-dsu/my-first-repo. As they speak, find each of the seven elements below on your screen.

Seven things to locate on the repo page



#	Element	What it tells you
1	Organization (aws-dsu)	Who owns this repo. aws-dsu is the GitHub organization hosting today's practice repo.
2	Repository name (my-first-repo)	The repo you will fork. Deliberately small and friendly.
3	README	Renders on the front page. This is where every project explains itself.
4	File tree	Every file in the repo. Click any folder to expand.
5	Commits tab	Every change ever made, with author and timestamp. This is what git actually is, made visible.
6	Green Code button	Holds the URL you will later use for <code>git clone</code> . Just notice it for now.
7	Fork button	Top-right. The one you click in five minutes.

Quick checklist — find each on your screen

- ☐ (1) aws-dsu in the breadcrumb
- ☐ (2) my-first-repo in the breadcrumb
- ☐ (3) README content on the front page
- ☐ (4) The file tree
- ☐ (5) The Commits tab (or commit count)
- ☐ (6) The green Code button
- ☐ (7) The Fork button in the top-right

WHY THIS MATTERS

Branches exist. You do not need to use them today. We name them and move on.

Part 3 · Hands-On #1 — Fork the repo (23–35 min)

YOUR TURN · 12 MINUTES

By the end, everyone has a fork.

Recipe — Fork `aws-dsu/my-first-repo`

▶ **Step 1.** Confirm you are signed in to `github.com`. Look for your avatar top-right.

IF YOU GET STUCK

If you do not see your avatar, the Fork button will be greyed out. Sign in first, then come back.

▶ **Step 2.** Navigate to `https://github.com/aws-dsu/my-first-repo`

YOU SHOULD SEE

The same page the instructor just toured — README, file tree, Code button, Fork button.

▶ **Step 3.** Click the **Fork** button in the top-right corner of the repo page.

YOU SHOULD SEE

A page titled “Create a new fork” with `aws-dsu/my-first-repo` listed as the source.

▶ **Step 4.** Leave every option at its default. Click the green **Create fork** button at the bottom.

YOU SHOULD SEE

A brief “Forking...” animation, then you land on a new repo page.

▶ **Step 5.** Look at the URL in your browser’s address bar.

Success check — Before vs. After

```
BEFORE:  github.com/  aws-dsu      /my-first-repo
          -----
          organization

AFTER:   github.com/  <your-username> /my-first-repo
          -----
          YOU
```

YOU SHOULD SEE

Your username (not `aws-dsu`) in the URL. Under the repo title you will also see a small line like:
forked from `aws-dsu/my-first-repo`

▶ **Step 6.** Copy your fork’s URL from the address bar. Paste it into the workshop chat as a check-in.

Inline troubleshooting

Problem	Fix
Fork button is greyed out or missing	You are not signed in. Sign in at <code>github.com</code> and try again.

Problem	Fix
You clicked Fork but nothing happened	Refresh the page. If still nothing, sign out and sign back in.
The URL still says aws-dsu	You did not complete the fork. Go back to the original repo and click Fork again.
You got an error about an existing fork	You already forked this repo (perhaps in pre-work). Go to <code>github.com/<your-username>/my-first-repo</code> directly — you are already done.
Page is loading very slowly	GitHub may be congested with 600 of us forking at once. Wait 60 seconds and refresh.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Your username in the URL is the marker of ownership. Anything you change now changes only your copy. The original `aws-dsu/my-first-repo` is untouched.

Part 4 · Hands-On #2 — Edit & commit (35–48 min)

YOUR TURN · 13 MINUTES

Make your first commit.

You should currently be on **your fork's** page: `github.com/<your-username>/my-first-repo`.

Recipe — Edit a file, commit the change

▶ **Step 1.** On your fork's front page, click the **README.md** file in the file tree.

YOU SHOULD SEE

The README open in “view” mode, with its rendered content.

▶ **Step 2.** Click the **pencil icon** in the top-right of the file view.

YOU SHOULD SEE

The README open in “edit” mode — a text editor with the file's contents, line numbers down the left side, and an Edit / Preview toggle at the top.

IF YOU GET STUCK

If you do not see the pencil icon, check your URL. If it says `aws-dsu/my-first-repo`, you are still on the original. The pencil only appears on repos you own. Go back to your fork (URL contains your username) and try again.

▶ **Step 3.** At the very **top** of the file, add a new line. Type exactly:

```
# My PartyRock app ideas
```

You can add it above whatever is already there. Press Enter to push the existing content down a line.

▶ **Step 4.** Scroll to the bottom of the page. You will see a section titled **Commit changes**.

▶ **Step 5.** In the **Commit message** box (the first text field), type:

```
my first commit
```

Leave the optional description box empty.

▶ **Step 6.** Confirm that “**Commit directly to the main branch**” is selected (it is the default).

▶ **Step 7.** Click the green **Commit changes** button.

YOU SHOULD SEE

The page jump back to a file view or repo view, with your new line at the top of the README.

Success check — Find your commit in history

▶ **Step 8.** Click the **Commits** tab (or the commit count link near the top of the file tree).

You should see a list of commits with the **newest at the top**. The newest one should show:

Field	What you should see
Author	Your GitHub username and avatar

Field	What you should see
Message	my first commit
Timestamp	“a few seconds ago” or similar
Commit SHA	A short hash like a1b2c3d

WHY THIS MATTERS

That is what git actually is — made visible. A permanent record of who changed what, when, and why.

Inline troubleshooting

Problem	Fix
I cannot find the pencil icon	You are on the original aws-dsu repo, not your fork. Check the URL contains your username.
The commit button is greyed out	You did not change the file content. Make sure you actually typed the new line, then it will activate.
I clicked away and lost my edit	The edit is gone. Click the pencil icon again and re-do it.
My commit is not showing on the Commits tab	Refresh the page. If still missing, you may have clicked away before clicking Commit changes — re-do the edit.
I accidentally committed to the wrong branch	Today everyone commits to main. If you see a different branch, that is fine for now — your commit still exists.
“This file has been edited by someone else”	Unlikely on your fork. If it happens, click Use this version and re-commit.

DROP IN CHAT — CHECK-IN FOR MODERATORS

Paste this line into the workshop chat:

First commit done — <paste your fork URL here>

Part 5 · Bonus — github.dev (48–55 min) — Optional

If you are behind, skip this section. The exit ticket only requires Parts 3 and 4.

github.dev is a full code editor that runs in a browser tab — the same one you use right now. No install. No download. No terminal.

The trick

- ▶ **Step 1.** Make sure you are on your fork's page: `github.com/<your-username>/my-first-repo`.
- ▶ **Step 2.** Press the **period key** (.) on your keyboard.

YOU SHOULD SEE

The URL change from `github.com/...` to `github.dev/...`, and a VS Code-style editor open in the same tab.

IF PRESSING . DOES NOTHING

Click somewhere on the GitHub page first (not in the URL bar) so the page has keyboard focus. Some keyboards require Shift + . — try that.

Or navigate directly to: `https://github.dev/<your-username>/my-first-repo`

What just opened

```
+-----+
| EXPLORER | | (file content opens here when |
| my-first-repo | | you click a file on the left) |
| README.md | | |
| [Files] [Find] | | |
| [Source Control] | | |
+-----+
```

Icon	What it does
Explorer (top-left)	The file tree, same as a desktop IDE.
Source Control (third icon down, looks like a branch)	Stage, commit, and sync — where you save changes.
Editor area	Click any file in the tree to open it. Drag a tab to split view side-by-side.

Make a second commit from github.dev

- ▶ **Step 1.** Click **README.md** in the Explorer panel on the left.
- ▶ **Step 2.** Make any small change — add a line, fix a typo, add a second heading.
- ▶ **Step 3.** Click the **Source Control** icon (third icon on the left sidebar, looks like a branching line).

YOU SHOULD SEE

Your changed file listed under “Changes.”

- ▶ **Step 4.** Hover over the file under “Changes” and click the **+** to stage it.
- ▶ **Step 5.** Type a commit message at the top — something like `second commit from github.dev`.
- ▶ **Step 6.** Click the **Commit** button (the checkmark above the message box).
- ▶ **Step 7.** Click the **Sync Changes** button when it appears.
- ▶ **Step 8.** Switch back to your `github.com/<your-username>/my-first-repo` tab and refresh.

YOU SHOULD SEE

Your second commit on the Commits tab.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Many faculty use `github.dev` for course-prep editing even when they have a local setup. It is the fastest way to make small changes without leaving the browser — and you have it now.

Part 6 · Preview & wrap (55–60 min)

What comes next — the SageMaker preview

In your first AWS Workshop Studio lab, you will run this command in a terminal:

```
git clone https://github.com/aws-samples/aws-mlu-eeep-generative-ai.git
```

That is the **same FEC muscle**, applied to the actual AWS course repository.

- `git clone` is the terminal equivalent of the Fork button — it copies the repo into your Studio environment.
- The same edit → commit loop applies, just typed instead of clicked.
- **You do not need to do this today.** Workshop Studio will provide the terminal in your lab session.

Three rules of public-repo hygiene

Before you make your next commit:

1. Every commit is permanent. Even if you delete a file later, the commit history still contains it. Treat every commit as public the moment you click the button.
2. No identifiable student data, ever. No names, no grades, no IEP / 504 information, no accommodation records, nothing FERPA-protected.
3. No institutional secrets. No internal budgets, personnel files, private policy drafts, or unpublished research data.

Exit ticket — drop these in chat (or the follow-up form)

My fork URL is _____

The commit message on my first commit was _____

One thing I will use my fork for in my teaching is _____

One question I still have about git is _____

After the session — Within 48 hours

Three small things to do before your first lab. Each takes under 5 minutes.

1. Bookmark your fork URL

You will need it in Workshop Studio. Save it somewhere you will actually find it again — browser bookmark, notes app, or a calendar event for your first lab.

2. Make a second commit

Any file, any change. The point is to reinforce the FEC loop while it is fresh. Suggested edits — pick one:

Discipline	Add this to your README
Humanities	A note: “What kind of generative-AI literacy could my students benefit from?”
STEM	A note about which MLU lab could anchor a lecture on prompt engineering or RAG.
Business	Which Module 3 application pattern (chatbot, agent, RAG) maps to a course you teach.
Health professions	Which responsible-AI lab (Module 2) connects to your existing ethics curriculum.
Education	How you might remix the MLU labs for a teacher-preparation course.
Social sciences	A policy or data-ethics question the responsible-AI module raises for your field.

3. Join the async help channel

Post one question — even a small one. The channel is open for 72 hours after the session.

Appendix A · Troubleshooting Quick Reference

If you see / experience...	Do this
"I do not have a GitHub account."	Create one at github.com/signup . You will miss the live hands-on — use the recording and office hours to catch up.
Fork button is greyed out or missing.	You are not signed in. Sign in at github.com and try again.
You clicked Fork but nothing happened.	Refresh, sign out, sign back in. GitHub may also be congested — wait 60 seconds and retry.
You cannot find the pencil icon.	You are looking at the original <code>aws-dsu/my-first-repo</code> , not your fork. The pencil only appears on repositories you can write to. Check the URL contains your username.
Commit button is greyed out.	You did not change the file content. Type something into the editor and it activates.
Your commit is not showing up.	Confirm you clicked Commit changes at the bottom of the edit screen (not just navigated away). Refresh the Commits tab.
Pressing the period key does nothing.	Click on the GitHub page first so it has keyboard focus. Some keyboards need Shift + . Or navigate directly to <code>github.dev/<your-username>/my-first-repo</code> .
"Is what I commit visible to everyone?"	Yes, if the fork is public (the default). Apply public-repo hygiene. To make it private: Settings → General → Danger Zone → Change visibility.
"Will this cost me money?"	No. GitHub free accounts include unlimited public repos, unlimited private repos, and unlimited github.dev .
"Do I need to install anything?"	Not for today. Workshop Studio will provide SageMaker Studio with git already installed.
You accidentally edited the wrong file.	Open the file's History (clock icon) and revert, or just commit a follow-up that re-fixes it. Nothing is ever truly lost.
You forked into the wrong account.	Delete the wrong fork in Settings → General → Danger Zone → Delete this repository, then fork again into the right account.

Appendix B · Reusable Git Cheat Sheet

The four-verb loop

Verb	What it does	Browser equivalent (today)	Terminal command (later)
clone	Copy a repository to your environment	Fork (creates a copy on GitHub)	<code>git clone <URL></code>
edit	Change one or more files	Pencil icon, or github.dev	(any text editor)
commit	Save a labeled snapshot	Commit changes button	<code>git commit -m "message"</code>
sync	Push up or pull down changes	Sync button in github.dev	<code>git push / git pull</code>

Terminal commands you will see in SageMaker Studio

```
git clone <URL>           # Copy a repository to your environment.
git pull                 # Get the latest changes from GitHub.
git status               # See which files have changed.
git add <file>           # Stage a file for the next commit.
git commit -m "message"  # Save a labeled snapshot.
git push                 # Send your commits up to GitHub.
```

The three rules of public-repo hygiene

- 1. Treat every commit as permanent and public.** Even if you delete a file later, the commit history still contains it.
- 2. No identifiable student data, ever.** No names, no grades, no IEP / 504 info, no accommodation records, no FERPA-protected content.
- 3. No institutional secrets.** No internal budgets, personnel files, private policy drafts, or unpublished research data.

Three things to do after the session

- 1.** Bookmark your fork URL.
- 2.** Make a second commit — anywhere, any file — to reinforce the loop.
- 3.** Join the async help channel and ask one question.

Appendix C · FEC-to-GitHub Worksheet

Fill this in during or after the session. This is the artifact you bring to your first Workshop Studio lab.

Planning item	Question	Your notes
GitHub account	What is your GitHub username?	
Account email	What email is associated with your account?	
Fork URL	What is the full URL of your fork of <code>aws-dsu/my-first-repo</code> ?	
First commit message	What did you write as your first commit message?	
F — Fork	When did you fork the practice repo (date)?	
E — Edit	Which file did you edit, and what did you change?	
C — Commit	What does the Commits tab show for your fork?	
Privacy check	Is your fork public or private? Are you comfortable with that?	
Course connection	Which course could most benefit from a forked copy of the MLU labs?	
github.dev tried?	Did you press <code>.</code> and open <code>github.dev</code> ? Will you use it for prep?	
Next step	What is the first thing you will do in your fork after the workshop?	
Open question	What is one thing about git that still feels unclear?	

THAT'S THE WHOLE LOOP

**Fork.
Edit.
Commit.**

See you in the lab.